

Russell Dudek

Director of Operations Candidate

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Anders Crabo
Managing Director
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Bravo's product is not advice. It is operational trust.

Growth-stage founders bring Bravo into the business because something consequential has become too complex to manage through instinct and heroics alone: demand and supply are drifting apart, inventory is trapping cash, partner performance is creating service risk, margins are leaking, or the founder has become the human integration layer across operations, sales, and finance. The Director of Operations has to earn enough trust to enter that system, enough judgment to find the real constraint, and enough discipline to leave behind a stronger operating mechanism.

That is the work I have done across very different operating environments. At Vape-Jet, I lead growth-stage operations across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, workflow systems, telemetry, training, and accountability. At Amazon, I led launch and execution in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually, building labor, throughput, escalation, and standard-work mechanisms. At Compunetics, I spent years leading engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in high-reliability environments.

I also want to be direct about the obvious concern: my career is not a traditional CPG path. I would not ask Bravo to overlook that, and I would not pretend familiarity I have not earned. My case is adjacent operating depth and learning speed: production, logistics, fulfillment, quality, distributed operations, partner coordination, systems integration, data-to-decision mechanisms, and team development. I know how to enter a complicated system without disrespecting the people already carrying it.

My candidate thesis for Bravo is simple: pattern recognition without pattern imposition. A useful playbook accelerates diagnosis, but each brand still needs the right mechanism for its stage, channel mix, cash reality, partner network, and team capability. I would approach engagements through a Client Ops Runbook: read the system, stabilize the flow, build the mechanism, and transfer the capability. The goal is not to make the client dependent on the Director. It is to help build an operating system the client can trust.

I made that thesis concrete in a role-specific candidate vision at russelldudek.github.io/Bravo/, including the operating model, evidence map, and 90-day plan. I would welcome a conversation about what you would need to see in the first 90 days to believe I am operating like a Bravo Director.

Carpe diem,
Russell Dudek